

Lance Clark

11/04/2001 03:46
PM

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Recalde/OCHA/NY@OCHA, Paolo Vacchina/OCHA/NY@OCHA
cc: Craig Duncan/OCHA/GE@OCHA, Ed Tsui/OCHA/NY@OCHA, Kelly
David-Toweh/OCHA/NY@OCHA, Helena Fraser/OCHA/NY@OCHA
Subject: Information Management Section - From: Putman-Cramer (ESB) -
FP: Lance Clark

1. Please find attached a memo from Gerhard Putman-Cramer forwarding a draft listing of possible tasks for the new IM Section in Geneva. I would note that Ed and I have already had one round of dialogue with Gerhard re the process of developing these tasks/TOR, and I can see from Gerhard's description of the process that we will need another one.
2. However, in the meanwhile we need to examine this draft carefully, and from two perspectives:
 - o What IM/IT tasks need to be done in Geneva?
 - o For which of these tasks should the IM Section have a major role, and for these, what should the roles be?
3. I would ask that you come to our 2:30 meeting this Thursday (for the IMTN) prepared to also discuss this document.

Thank you.

----- Forwarded by Lance Clark/OCHA/NY on 11/04/2001 03:47 PM -----

 **Laila Ido**

11/04/2001 03:10
PM

To: Lance Clark/OCHA/NY@OCHA
cc: Maria Luisa Ng/OCHA/NY@OCHA, MarieJo
Floret/OCHA/NY@OCHA, Lambert Hogenhout/OCHA/NY@OCHA,
Paolo Vacchina/OCHA/NY@OCHA, Kelly
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Subject: Information Management Section - From: Putman-Cramer (ESB) -
FP: Lance Clark

FROM: Putman-Cramer (ESB)
TO: Ross Mountain
SUBJECT: Information Management Section
FOCAL POINT: Lance Clark
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BUREAU DE LA COORDINATION
DES AFFAIRES HUMANITAIRES

OCHA

OFFICE FOR THE COORDINATION
OF HUMANITARIAN AFFAIRS

MEMORANDUM

A - TO: Mr. Ross Mountain
Assistant Emergency Relief
Coordinator and Director
OCHA-Geneva

REF: GPC/ml.doc

DE - FROM: Gerhard Putman-Cramer
Deputy Director and Chief, ESB

GENEVE, 11 April 2001

OBJET - SUBJECT: Information Management Section

Please find attached a summary of Thomas' ideas - as we agreed that he should prepare.

Obviously, all of this should be bounced off/discussed with AERIMB in New York, to be further "refined"/added to/subtracted from and then transformed, with AERIMB's approval, into the Section's mandated tasks.

I would wish to have these discussions, if you agree, upon Thomas' return from leave, together with yourself, Hans Zimmermann and Craig Duncan (on the Geneva side), in the week of 23 avril.

In the meantime, I am copying this already to Ed and Lance, as well as to Hans, Craig and Bob Turner, for their preliminary review.

With thanks.

Gerhard

OCHA/NY

APR 11 2001

Focal Point: LC by: _____
Info copy to: ET, MJE, LH,
PV, KDT

CC: Mr. E. Tsui (by fax) +1 212 963-1040 ✓
Mr. L. Clark (by fax) ✓
Mr. H. Zimmermann
Mr. R. Turner
Mr. C. Duncan

Information Management Section

1. OCHA Internal Information Management

1.1. Technical application support and project supervision (e.g. FTS)

OCHA has developed or is developing applications to meet specific requirements such as Financial Tracking of Donor Contributions. These systems are designed by external consultants and require maintenance after they have been handed over to OCHA, in order to ensure data-integrity and smooth performance of the tools.

Activities:

- data cleaning
- training of new users and data-entry operators
- creation of documentation (help files)

Expected result:

- smooth functioning of existing applications to maintain confidence of their users and to strengthen OCHA's credibility

In cooperation with:

- RCB
- Field Offices
- AO

1.2. Maintenance of Contacts Database(s) (compatibility with OCHA Central Registry and Reliefweb LotusNotes Contacts Database)

OCHA is maintaining several Contact overviews, some of which are accessible in databases (Lotus Contacts List), others are distributed in file format (e.g. MS-Word) and some are available only as hard-copies.

There is a need to maintain these contact records in a relational database format in order to enable users (OCHA-staff) to utilize the data in their daily work. This includes:

- 1) Rapid lookup of persons data (e.g. telephone)
- 2) Creation of customized lists for mailing (fax, letters and e-mail) and maintenance of rosters and networks, such as UNDAC, INSARAG, Environmental Experts, OCHA Focal Points.

Activities:

- Development of standardized database
- Negotiation of automatic data exchange and/or outsourcing of data maintenance with respective organizations and entities
- User and administrator training
- System maintenance

In cooperation with:

- ESB
- RCB
- AO
- OCHA-NY (ITS)

1.3. Document Management Concept

OCHA-Geneva Registry is currently developing a tool to scan documents to make them available electronically. This feature would facilitate the search for documents according to defined criteria. In addition, the tool should provide a possibility for electronic fax distribution. This would ensure that mailing lists are generated from a database and sent automatically by a dedicated computer (server). This would accelerate the transmission of faxes and save manpower in registry for other information management tasks.

In cooperation with:

- ESB
- RCB
- AO
- UNOG

*Responsible for
- data cleaning
- training of new users and data-entry operators
- creation of documentation (help files)*

*Responsible for
- development of standardized database
- negotiation of automatic data exchange and/or outsourcing of data maintenance with respective organizations and entities
- user and administrator training
- system maintenance*

1.4. Development of e-mail policy

An e-mail policy needs to be developed to meet the following urgent requirements:

- standardized filing and archiving of e-mail messages
- reduction of cc abuse (categorization in 'must know' should know' recipients of messages)
- establishment of mailboxes that can be shared by different functions

In cooperation with:

- ESB
- RCB
- OCHA-NY ((IAS, ITS)

1.5. Focal Point for IT support provided by UNOG

IMS to provide a focal point for UNOG IT services to coordinate requests for support

In cooperation with:

- UNOG/ESS

1.6. Improvement of OCHA's IT management capacity (training, documentation)

Develop a training concept to establish surge capacity for computer maintenance within OCHA-Geneva staff. This would comprise:

- Identify maintenance activities that can be performed by specific user-levels (beginner, advanced, expert, UNOG-administrator)
- Provide respective training and follow-up support

In cooperation with:

- ESB
- RCB
- UNOG/ESS

1.7. Development of Workflow Management Tools

It is essential that concepts for workflow management be established, including the development of electronic support tools for revision of documents and financial, administrative and personnel issues (contracts, etc.). Reference is made to the recent recommendation for the development of an electronic 'FAP-matrix' (by David Bassiouni), to facilitate the processing of financial/administrative/personnel issues between OCHA HQ and field offices.

In cooperation with:

- ESB
- RCB
- AO
- OCHA-NY (IAS)

1.8. Maintenance of OCHA Online

Develop a standardized layout for OCHA-Online and maintain information integrity and ensure regular updates.

In cooperation with:

- ESB
- RCB
- OCHA-NY (IAS)

1.9. Maintenance of the OCHA Duty System

Facilitate the development of a joint OCHA-Geneva Duty System and coordinate the implementation

In cooperation with:

- ESB
- RCB
- AO

1.10. Statistics support

Facilitate the development of statistical tools for the interpretation of available data with respect to donor contributions and vulnerability, in close cooperation with the Early Warning and Contingency Planning

This requires more thinking and is part of the ITM discussion

Unit, IAS, OCHA-NY.

In cooperation with:

- RCB
- OCHA-NY (IAS)

1.11 SitRep sending procedures

Maintain and improve the technical procedures for sending of Situation Reports, including maintenance of recipient lists and training for P and G staff in OCHA Geneva.

In cooperation with:

- RCB

1.1.2 Early-warning and News monitoring

Ensure that procedures are established for news-monitoring and early warning of respective stakeholders in case of sudden onset emergencies. These procedures should be coordinated with OCHA-NY (IAS).

In cooperation with:

- ESB
- RCB
- OCHA-NY (IAS)

2. External Information Management, between OCHA and its Stakeholders

2.1. OCHA Central Register

Develop and maintain a database for internal and external use through the Internet on

- Emergency Contacts, including rosters of expertise (e.g. environment, surge capacity) and sectoral focal points (e.g. customs offices)
- Emergency Stockpiles and private enterprise offering emergency relief services and products (e.g. helicopter transport)
- Military and Civil Defence Assets and other support services (Service Packages, UNDAC support modules, etc.)

In cooperation with:

- ESB
- Donor Governments
- Relief organizations, including Red Cross Movement
- Private enterprise
- RCB

2.2. Virtual OSOCC

Maintain and further develop the Virtual OSOCC as platform for rapid information exchange during sudden onset emergencies.

In cooperation with:

- ESB
- Donor Governments and relief organizations, including IFRC
- RCB

2.3. Technical advice for the establishment of compatible and state-of-the-art technology for On-Site Operations and Joint Logistics Coordination Centres

There should be a standardized approach in equipping ad-hoc Field Coordination Centres (OSOCC/LOC) in terms of logistics and IDP tracking databases, data sharing through local and wide computer networks.

In Cooperation with:

- ESB (FCSS and MCLDSS)

2.4. Operations Coordination Centre

Facilitate the development for the use of an operations coordination centre concept during sudden onset emergencies, to facilitate information exchange and decision making processes within OCHA, the UN family as well as all stakeholders in emergency response. This would not only be a physical area (room) within OCHA Geneva, but rather a concept comprising several components of information management,

*Global Policy
This is a global
policy that is
relevant to all
regions and
all sectors*

*Other was an
few notes to
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*to be used
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*to be used
as a model
for other
centres*

*to be used
as a model
for other
centres*

such as Virtual OSOCC, video/telephone conferencing, regular and ad-hoc briefings/meetings, etc.

In cooperation with:

- ESB
- RCB
- Stakeholders in emergency response, such as Donor and recipient governments, relief organizations, IFRC/ICRC, UN agencies, etc.